

Defining player's role

In a game it is very important for the player to understand what he is pretending to be in the game. Playing games often involve playing a role of some sort.

Like in Monopoly, the player plays the role of a tycoon from Russia. Sometimes, the roles in a game are multi-faced: In a sports game, the player's role changes from being an athlete on the field to the coach who is planning the strategy. Hence, it is very important for the designer to define the player's roles clearly as this defines what players actions will be in the game. The designer needs to know what activities he/she is offering to the player.

It is very important to understand that the player has bought your game to play- that is to act; not to hear or see. Hence, interactivity is very important in the game as mentioned earlier in the properties that define games.

Choosing a genre

"Genre is a category of games characterized by a particular set of challenges, regardless of setting of game-world content"

– Ernest.W.Adams, *Game Designer*.

Genre, by definition refers to the context of the work. Historical fiction, romance fiction, spy fiction, and so on are genres of popular fiction. In games, genre refers to the types of challenges that a game offers. Action games are one type of genre; whatever is the theme of the game-world – old west or space or an army battle ground, they are all still action games. Genre restricts the designer's mind to think in a particular direction which is very good as greater the restrictions of theme and genre, easier for the game designer!

Types of game genres

- ▶ **Action games:** An action game is one in which majority of challenges presented are tests of player's physical skills and coordination. Apart from this, puzzle-solving, exploration challenges might be presented as well.
- ▶ **Sub-genres:** Shooter games such as *Call of Duty*, combat games such as *God of War*.
- ▶ **Strategy games:** Derived from the Greek word "Strategia", which means Generalship; these games expect player to use his decision-making skills to take decisions, keeping in mind the outcome. All Real-Time Strategy games such as *Myth*, *Age of Empires* come under this genre.
- ▶ **Role-playing games:** In a role-playing game, players assume the roles of characters in a fictional world. There are several types of role-playing